

Fig. 4: How it fetches appropriate webpages

links on those pages and fetch the pages they link to, and so on.

There are billions of pages stored across thousands of machines. Spiders extract the data on webpages from websites and store it in a page repository. Then data is sent to an indexing module, which strips the contents from these pages and extracts key elements like title tag, description tag, data about images and internal links. Basically, the indexing module provides a really condensed summary of each webpage, like cliff notes. It then puts the data in a database referred to as index. All these activities go on all the time, regardless of whether a query is made for search or not.

When a query is made

When the user types in a query in Google search box (Fig. 3), the query is broken down into a language that

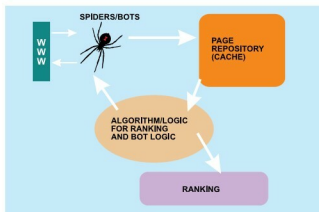


Fig. 5: How Websites are ranked

the search engine can understand. The query module extracts thousands and thousands of results back from databases/indices. On the results obtained, the ranking module applies a formula to rank the pages, presenting the user with the most relevant pages in the order of ranking.

How Websites are ranked

Google employs Link based algorithm to determine the rank of results (Fig. 5). For this, the algorithm checks for link popularity (how many links the page has), page rank (how powerful the link is), link reputation (how is the quality of links – whether they are from high-ranking websites and whether the link text is relevant to the page subject) and many other factors in order to provide ranked results.

The results are presented to the user as per the ranking. ●

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